

Orthogonal trajectory

Definition: The angle of intersection between two curves is defined as the angle between the tangents of the curves at the point of intersection.



Orthogonal trajectory: A family of curves that intersects a given family of curves at right angles is called orthogonal trajectory.

Method (1) Find the diff. eq. of a given family of curves (1-parameter)

(2) Replace $\frac{dy}{dx}$ by $-\frac{dx}{dy}$ and solve the diff. eq.

Ex. $x^2 + y^2 = a^2$, a - arbitrary constant

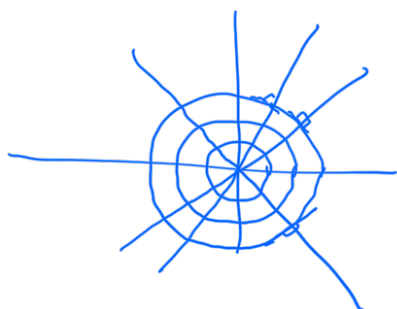
Soln: $2x + 2y \frac{dy}{dx} = 0 \Rightarrow x + y \frac{dy}{dx} = 0$.

Replace $\frac{dy}{dx}$ by $-\frac{dx}{dy}$,

$$x + y \left(-\frac{dx}{dy}\right) = 0 \Rightarrow \frac{dx}{x} = \frac{dy}{y}$$

On integrating, $\ln y = \ln x + \ln c$

$\Rightarrow \boxed{y = cx} \rightarrow$ orthogonal trajectory.



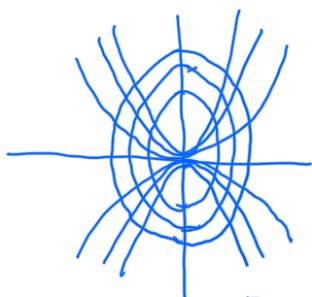
Ex $y^2 = ax$
Sol: $2y \frac{dy}{dx} = a \Rightarrow 2y \frac{dy}{da} = \frac{y^2}{x}$

$$\Rightarrow \frac{dy}{da} = \frac{y}{2x}$$

Replac $\frac{dy}{da}$ by $-\frac{dx}{dy}$,

$$-\frac{dx}{dy} = \frac{y}{2x} \Rightarrow 2x dx + y dy = 0$$

$$\Rightarrow \boxed{x^2 + \frac{y^2}{2} = C.}$$



Ex. Find orthogonal trajectories of

(1) $x^2 - y^2 = C$ (2) $y = 4x + C$ (3) $y = \frac{C}{x}$

(4) $y = 2x^2 + C$ (5) $y = Ce^{-3x}$ (6) $4x^2 + y^2 = C.$

In Polar co-ordinate: (1) Find the diff. eq
 (2) Replac $\frac{1}{r} \frac{dr}{d\theta}$ by $-r \frac{d\theta}{dr}$ and solve.

Ex $r = 2a \cos \theta$, a - arbitrary constant.

Sol: $\frac{dr}{d\theta} = -2a \sin \theta \Rightarrow \frac{dr}{d\theta} = -\frac{r \sin \theta}{\cos \theta}$

$$\Rightarrow \frac{1}{r} \frac{dr}{d\theta} = -\tan \theta$$

Replac $\frac{1}{r} \frac{dr}{d\theta} = -r \frac{d\theta}{dr}$, thus giving, $-r \frac{d\theta}{dr} = -\tan \theta.$

$$\Rightarrow \frac{d\theta}{\tan \theta} = \frac{dr}{r}$$

$$\Rightarrow \ln r = \ln \sin \theta + \ln C$$

$$\Rightarrow \boxed{r = C \sin \theta.}$$

Existence and Uniqueness theorem for IVP

Initial value problem (IVP) for the first order diff eq:

$$\frac{dy}{dx} = f(x, y), \quad y(a) = b.$$

Q.1 Does solution of IVP always exists?

Ans: No.

Ex. $|y'| + |y| = 0, \quad y(0) = 1.$

$\Downarrow$

$$|y'| = 0 \text{ \& \& } |y| = 0$$

$\Downarrow$

$$y' = 0$$

$\Downarrow$

$$y = c$$

$\Downarrow$

$$y = 0$$

$\searrow$

$$y = 0.$$

$\therefore y = 0$ is the only solution of $|y'| + |y| = 0$ but it does not satisfy the initial condition $y(0) = 1$. Therefore, the given IVP has no solution.

Q.2 If solution exists, is it unique?

Ans: Not necessary.

Ex $\frac{dy}{dx} = y^{1/3}, \quad y(0) = 0.$

Clearly, $y = 0$ is a solution.

$$\frac{dy}{y^{1/3}} = dx$$

$$\Rightarrow \frac{3}{2} y^{2/3} = x + c$$

$$\Rightarrow y = \left[\frac{2(x+c)}{3} \right]^{3/2}$$

$$\because y(0) = 0, \quad 0 = \left(\frac{2c}{3} \right)^{3/2} \Rightarrow c = 0$$

$$\therefore y = \left(\frac{2x}{3} \right)^{3/2}; \quad x \geq 0 \text{ is another solution.}$$

Ex. show that the above IVP has infinitely many solutions.

Hint: Take $y = \begin{cases} 0 & 0 \leq x < a \\ \left(\frac{2}{3}(x-a)\right)^{3/2}, & x \geq a \end{cases}, \quad a > 0.$

Is y differentiable?

Ex. show that IVP $\frac{dy}{dx} = \frac{3x^2 + 4x + 2}{2y - 2}; \quad y(0) = 1.$

has more than one solution.